EDITORIAL DIGEST

THIS WEEK IN BITCOIN CORE

2026-09-28 – 2026-10-04

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Intensified focus on Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC):** Multiple discussions highlight the growing importance of PQC, exploring its implications for both L1 and L2 (Lightning Network) security, and initiating technical deep-dives into potential PQC output types for future protocol upgrades.

Complete pull request breakdowns, maintainer reviews, and developer discussions across Bitcoin Core.

WEEKLY VELOCITY & ALLOCATION

DEV VITAL SIGNS

Coverage: 2026-09-28 – 2026-10-04

24 ▼ -31% WoW
Merged PRs
vs 35 prior week

505 ▼ -1% WoW
Peer Reviews
vs 510 prior week

20 ▼ -5% WoW
Research Threads
vs 21 prior week

+2 ▼ -60% WoW
New Contributors
vs 5 prior week

ENGINEERING SUBSYSTEM ALLOCATION

24 Merges Categorized by Technical Domain



- **Maintenance & Tech Debt**
  18 75%
  CI, CMake, Tests & Refactors
- **Security & Consensus**
  6 25%
  Consensus rules & cryptographic logic
- **Wallet & User Tools**
  3 13%
  maxfeerate, atomic encryption
- **Performance & Optimization**
  2 8%
  Mempool unbroadcast txids
- **Strategic Initiatives**
  1 4%
  Block template mgr, kernel
- **Network & Privacy**
  1 4%
  BIP 352, I2P, private broadcast

FEATURED MERGE

SPOTLIGHT PR

Maintenance & Tech Debt Milestone

PR #36233 • hebasto

guix: Update time-machine to 60f6956aeffa7f30285745bd0ea615e9acfc74f8

This PR updates the Guix build system's 'time-machine' reference, ensuring that reproducible builds of Bitcoin Core continue to use a consistent and verified set of dependencies. This is crucial for maintaining the integrity and trustworthiness of Bitcoin Core binaries.

RESEARCH & DISCUSSIONS

PROTOCOL DEBATES

Delving Bitcoin & Core Dev Meeting

DELVING

Shielded Bitcoin: Private Transfers on the Bitcoin L1

We're exploring how to enable private Bitcoin transactions directly on the main blockchain, focusing on a secure and lightweigh...

DELVING

Stats on compact block reconstructions

We're analyzing how quickly new blocks are shared across the Bitcoin network to ensure transactions confirm reliably and the ne...

DELVING

What does "post-quantum" actually mean for a Bitcoin L2 when settlement still happens on a non-PQ L1?

Developers are exploring how to future-proof Bitcoin's off-chain payment channels against quantum computing threats, ensuring s...

DELVING

PQC output type discussion

Developers are actively planning for Bitcoin's future security against quantum computers by exploring new transaction types. Th...